

Owen Hejna

Ecologist and Educator

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Website · LinkedIn · GitHub

Education

B.S., Ecology

Graduated *cum laude*, May 2024

Loyola University Chicago

University Research: Laboratory of Bioinformatics, Laboratory of Aquatic Ecology, Urban Agriculture Program

Experience

Volunteer Engagement Coordinator

Since August 2026

Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role

Secretive Marshbird Coordinator

Since February 2026

Indiana Audubon Society, Independent Contractor Role

Program Instructor II

Since February 2026

Evanston Ecology Center, Evanston, IL

Community Science Coordinator

April – December 2025

Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

Summer Research Intern

June – September 2024

Urban Wildlife Institute at Lincoln Park Zoo, Chicago, IL

DNA Barcoding of Neotropical Fishes Intern

June – August 2023

The Field Museum, Chicago, IL

Shoreline Maintenance Technician

June – August 2022

Chicago Botanic Garden, Glencoe, IL

Volunteer Affiliations

Midwest Society for Acoustic Ecology

Since May 2026

Member

Illinois Bat Working Group

Since March 2026

Member

Urban Wildlife Institute

Since January 2026

GIS Analyst, Acoustic Analyst

Chicago Ornithological Society (COS)

Since November 2025

Calumet Conservation Committee, MAPS Bird Bander (2026)

Urban Rivers

Since June 2025

Educator

National Society of Collegiate Scholars

2020 – 2024

Member

Scientific Articles

Planet Forward

Published October 2025

Chicago's people-powered Bat Tracker: Citizen scientists seek a different bat signal

Attended Events

Indiana Dunes Birding Festival

May 2026

Tour Guide, Volunteer

Midwest Bat Working Group Annual Meeting

April 2026

Urban Wildlife Information Network Summit

September 2025

Midwest Beaver Summit

August 2024

Certifications

Bird Guide Ambassador

Issued Aug 2026

Indiana Audubon

Adult First Aid CPR/AED All Ages

Issued Jun 2026

Health and Safety Institute

Acoustic Bat Call Identification

Issued May 2025

Vesper Bat Detection Services

Mandated Reporter

Issued May 2025

Illinois Department of Children and Family Services